heart to begin. In fact I scarcely knew which way fate would lead me, and began to entertain serious ideas of turning Turk that I might have no trouble in entering into futurity, but quietly smoking my pipe might leave every earthly care to God His prophet. However I am rejoiced to say that the clouds are now disappearing and I can, with some degree of comfort, sit down to let you into my future movements.

I have before mentioned Sadik Bey's departure from Constantinople. — Mr. Fowler's coming down to Smirna after we had been together some weeks, every body and every thing led us to think that nothing could prevent a war between the three powers and Turkey.[1] The news from Persia was of the worst description. We heard of nothing but the Russians gaining victories, making advances etc. all of which you have of course seen and I need not here enter into. We anticipated nothing but being obliged to leave Smirna and going God only knew whither, our proceeding to Persia appeared for the present impossible. We heard nothing from Sadik Bey who promised to write from Erzeroum, the bad state of the Roads, dreadful weather, the unsettled political events between Russia and Persia, the former of whom was said to be in possession of all the passes, the great danger from Koords and other bandits, and his bad state of health made us have every fear for his safety. Indeed the Pacha of Erzeroum the frontier town of Turkey would not allow travellers to proceed therefore we had the greatest doubt of Sadik Bey's reaching his destination. He desired us to remain quiet for three months in which time he hoped to send us the money and make every arrangement necessary for the journey.

It is now exactly three months since his departure and we have heard nothing from him, therefore have concluded that I should set out alone for Persia which is now practicable as the Russians have agreed to the terms of a peace and to all appearances there is no danger of a war between Turkey and England.[2] I apply here for a Teskeret to proceed to Constantinople from whence I get my firman to go on, every body here appears to think I shall get permission to proceed. We have decided on this step with the concurrence of Mr. Hanson who decidedly considers it the most practical way of acting. In case of Sadik Bey's death, which God forbid, it is necessary to wind up his affairs and no body can do this better than Fowler or myself. Should he be well he will be delighted to hear the present state of affairs and I shall bring information which it is impossible he can procure from any other source, as all communication has been

[1] The Holy Alliance (England, France, and Russia) were threatening to intervene actively in the Greek war of independence.

[2] The Russo-Persian War was brought to an end by the Treaty of Turkomanchai, in February, 1828. This left Russia, who had assumed the role of protector of Christianity, with her hands free for her war with Turkey.

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